



YOU ARE **9 WEEKS AND 2 DAYS**

215 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The baby now begins to bend their wrists. The natural position is for the limbs to be slightly bent at all joints, especially in the early stages. There is a more distinct neck area as the baby's head is now slightly lifted off the chest.

“The muscular diaphragm that will eventually enable your baby to breathe—and hiccup—is developing now.”

As your baby's lungs develop in the chest, there is nothing to separate them from the stomach, liver, and bowel in what will later become their abdominal cavity.

In adults, the chest is separated from the abdomen by the muscular diaphragm. When we breathe, the diaphragm moves downward and the ribs expand outward. This process allows air to enter the lungs.

Your baby's diaphragm forms from four in-folds of tissue. First seen at around this week of pregnancy, these folds gradually expand inward, fusing together and closing the space by the end of this week.

In the center of the diaphragm there are openings for the esophagus to the stomach, main artery to the body—the aorta, and main vein returning blood from the lower body, the inferior vena cava. As your pregnancy progresses, muscle fibers gradually strengthen your baby's diaphragm, and later in the pregnancy your baby will make breathing movements.